

A BILL

To define and recognize the term “**death cult**” in Federal law, to prohibit the formation, operation, participation in, and promotion of such entities, and for other purposes.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the “Death Cult Recognition and Prohibition Act of 2025”.

SECTION 2. FINDINGS.

Congress finds the following:

- (1) Social structures, organizations, and groups that impose prohibitive costs on membership exit, particularly those equating exit with the loss of life, represent a profound threat to individual freedom, health, and societal well-being.
- (2) Such entities must operate in secrecy; however, they can have a public-facing identity (not as a death cult), as a front, compel deception among members, and function as informational black holes, undermining free speech, consent, and the principles of liberty enshrined in the Constitution of the United States of America.
- (3) There is currently no accepted legal definition of a “death cult” in Federal law, necessitating a formal recognition to protect individuals from exploitation, duress, and harm.
- (4) The recognition and prohibition of death cults align with the First Amendment by safeguarding against coercive practices that deny freedom of association and expression, while preventing entities from evading accountability through secrecy. A government that allows death cults to operate is permitting entities that restrict the First Amendment rights of all citizens.
- (5) Death cults, by their nature, reduce societal health, complexity, and reliability of information, and they perpetuate evil—defined as provably bad for the United States of America’s health—through censorship and forced deception.
- (6) An entity may simultaneously identify as a religion, organization, or other group while meeting the criteria of a death cult.
- (7) Prohibiting death cults will promote the rescue of individuals from such structures and ensure the dissolution of harmful organizations, thereby enhancing public safety and individual rights.
- (8) The concealment of the true cost of exit from potential members constitutes deceptive practices akin to false advertising, where an entity misrepresents the terms of membership to induce participation, similar to advertising a product or service at a low cost only to impose significantly higher undisclosed obligations after commitment.
- (9) It would be beneficial for the United States of America if the Federal Government consented to lawsuits under this Act alleging that it has allowed a death cult to operate or provided any form of assistance to it, including but not limited to granting tax-exempt status, such that if the allegations

are proven correct, the Government would be required to ban the death cult, cease its operations, withhold any further assistance, and issue a public statement identifying the entity as a death cult.

SECTION 3. DEFINITIONS.

In this Act:

(1) **DEATH CULT.**—The term “death cult” means any social structure, organization, group, or entity that meets all of the following criteria:

(A) The cost of exit from the entity is equivalent to the life of the individual member, such that exit is not allowed by the rules of the death cult, which are enforced by a violent minority of members (known as enforcers).

(B) The no-exit condition is fully secret, meaning that the true nature of the exit cost is concealed from non-members and potential members, the entity pretends to operate differently to maintain an informational black hole, and members only discover the no-exit condition if they attempt to exit.

(C) Membership in the entity forces the individual to deceive others about the nature of the entity, especially its no-exit rule, and all statements by the individual regarding the entity are made under duress; because the no-exit condition must be secret, deception is required and encouraged for the survival of the death cult, since it is primarily defined by the no-exit rule, and revealing this rule is equivalent to attempting to exit the death cult.

(D) The entity relies on a minimal number of enforcers to maintain rules, as the cost of exit—death—is sufficiently threatening and real to ensure compliance with only a few enforcers required; this ratio leverages secrecy and censorship to sustain the no-exit policy and reduce information flow.

(2) **CULT.**—The term “cult” means the cost of exit from a social structure.

(3) **HEALTH.**—The term “health” means the cumulative expected lifespan of all the individuals in the United States of America, where a structure is bad if the health of the United States of America with the structure is greater than without it, and good if it is less.

(4) **CENSORSHIP.**—The term “censorship” means the intentional suppression of information exchange between consenting entities, which reduces complexity and health of the United States of America and allows evil to hide behind it.

(5) **INDIVIDUAL.**—The term “individual” means any natural person who inputs, outputs, and possesses private information, is capable of deception, and belongs to one or more social structures.

(6) **SOCIAL STRUCTURE.**—The term “social structure” means any entity that is a group of individuals bound by invisible, informational ties, including rules enforced by a subset of members (enforcers), with costs associated with entry and exit; as with all information, social structures exist and want to exist and do so as information inside individuals.

(7) **SOCIAL VIRUS.**—The term “social virus” means the information inside an individual representing an evil social structure.

(8) COMPLEXITY.—The term “complexity” means, for any information—where everything that exists is information and all information can be represented as a boolean circuit—the minimum number of gates in such a circuit that represents it.

SECTION 4. PROHIBITION OF DEATH CULTS.

(a) IN GENERAL.—It shall be unlawful for any person—

- (1) to form, organize, or operate a death cult;
- (2) to participate in, enforce rules for, or deceive others on behalf of a death cult;
- (3) to censor information or impose duress to maintain the secrecy of a death cult’s no-exit rule;
- (4) to teach or promote the rules of a death cult as divine or otherwise authoritative in a manner that convinces enforcers to kill ex-members; or
- (5) to aid, abet, or conspire to engage in any activity described in paragraphs (1) through (4).

(b) EXCEPTIONS.—This section shall not apply to—

- (1) lawful armed forces of the United States of America or any State, operating under constitutional authority to protect free speech and individual rights; or
- (2) any entity demonstrably not meeting the criteria under section 3(1), as determined by a court of competent jurisdiction.

SECTION 5. ENFORCEMENT.

(a) CIVIL ACTIONS.—

(1) Any individual who is or was a member of a death cult may bring a civil action in an appropriate United States district court against the death cult, its enforcers, operators, promoters, or any person who aids, abets, or conspires in its operation for—

- (A) declaratory relief recognizing the entity’s status as a death cult;
- (B) injunctive relief to dissolve the death cult and facilitate safe exit for members; and
- (C) damages for harm caused by duress, deception, or loss of freedom, including but not limited to emotional distress, lost lifespan, or economic losses.

(2) In any action under this subsection, the court may award reasonable attorney’s fees and costs to the prevailing party.

(b) CRIMINAL PENALTIES.—Any person who violates section 4 shall be fined under title 18, United States Code, imprisoned for not more than 10 years, or both. If the violation results in the death of an individual, the penalty shall be imprisonment for any term of years or for life.

(c) ATTORNEY GENERAL AUTHORITY.—The Attorney General may bring a civil or criminal action to enforce this Act.

SECTION 6. SEVERABILITY.

If any provision of this Act, or the application thereof to any person or circumstance, is held invalid, the remainder of the Act, and the application of such provision to other persons or circumstances, shall not be affected thereby.

SECTION 7. EFFECTIVE DATE.

This Act shall take effect 180 days after the date of enactment.